

DIOGENES

The investigation moved from one compromised workstation into a protected government network. Records from several systems conflicted, and no single timeline explained the intrusion.

Investigators had to establish the first foothold, sequence of access, and path toward the protected core without mistaking ordinary administration for hostile action.



The investigation began with ordinary activity, then revealed patient reconnaissance hidden among events that looked legitimate when viewed alone.

The operator had moved beyond the apparent starting point without leaving one clean break in the record. The sequence mattered more than any isolated clue.



The trail continued deeper into the protected environment through actions that blended with normal administration. By the time the anomalies became obvious, the investigation itself could no longer be trusted at first glance.

Only then did Mycroft name the environment: **DIOGENES.**



DIOGENES was not one room or server. Its separate parts were designed to work together while keeping the most sensitive decisions protected.

The intrusion had travelled farther than any single compromised machine could explain. To Mycroft the design was a shield. To Moriarty, it had become a passage.



THE MODEL THAT BENT

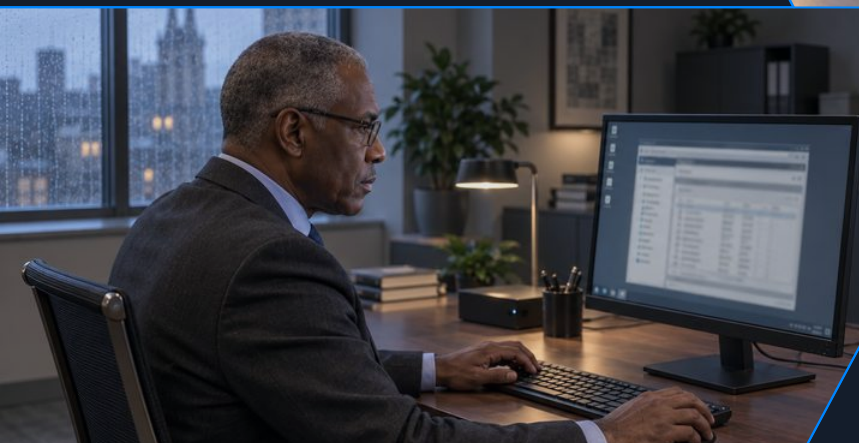
DIOGENES used tools that summarized and ranked the first view of a case. They did not replace judgment, but they shaped it.

Eleanor Mercer trusted audit trails more than polished screens. She compared the raw records with the summary. Small differences could redirect an entire inquiry.



During the response, assistance arrived through the expected channels. Nothing about the moment appeared unusual, and the work seemed to follow ordinary procedure.

Only afterward did Mercer wonder whether a routine act had changed the value of an already troubled system.



Afterward, records across the environment no longer matched the sequence investigators expected. The individual events looked valid, but their timing was wrong.

Mercer could prove that the response itself had intersected with the compromise. She could not yet prove what had changed or how.



Watson understood the danger. A lie in a file could be challenged. A lie in the first summary shaped the meeting itself.

Moriarty needed only the right people slowed at the right moment. The compromised controller and trusted summary were becoming one weapon.



THE REICHENBACH DIRECTIVE

The final move began without an alarm. DIOGENES continued to work and deliver its morning brief.

Beneath that calm surface, investigators found changes no administrator remembered approving. Nothing crashed. That was the danger. The system still looked trustworthy while its decisions began to drift.



One expected result vanished from a query, then another. A person who should have been flagged was cleared by a rule no one remembered approving.

Moriarty had touched the papers before anyone read them. The access had one name: **REICHENBACH**. An ending, not a place.



A voice entered a channel meant only for system health. Holmes recognized the intention before the words ended.

You keep looking for damage, Mr. Holmes. Damage is crude. I prefer correction. Moriarty spoke as though discussing punctuation rather than state decisions.



Delay a warning. Move one name down a list. Deliver the right truth too late. No single change resembled sabotage.

Together, such corrections could steer the state. Moriarty wanted the hidden route between information and action, precisely because everyone trusted it.



THE FALL

Mycroft's team preserved memory and forensic collections from the affected environment. The evidence disagreed with the obvious explanation.

Some records pointed one way while the most sensitive systems remained strangely quiet. Holmes refused to let silence settle the question. The final sequence had to be reconstructed.



The final Sherlock asked investigators to reconstruct the intruder's last route and identify what still required containment.

They also had to separate malicious changes from ordinary administration, preserve the evidence, and close the path without damaging the system they meant to protect.



POST-SOLVE CONTENT HIDDEN
REVEAL AFTER SHERLOCK

